

TRUSTAN PRICE

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Master of Computer Science

Champaign, IL

2026 – 2027

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign

Bachelor of Science in **Statistics**; Minors in **Computer Science** and Data Science

Champaign, IL

2022 – 2025

SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, R, JavaScript, CSS, HTML, C++, Java

Libraries: Pandas, NumPy, Scikit-Learn, Matplotlib, Boto3, TensorFlow, PyTorch

Frameworks & Tools: CI/CD, Azure DevOps, Git, Flask, React.js, Streamlit, Vercel, Power BI, Tableau, Grafana

Cloud & Platforms: AWS (S3, Lambda, EC2, SageMaker, CloudFormation, API Gateway)

EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Intern

Aug 2026 – Present

Synchrony

- Developing and deploying an application to Synchrony's newly provisioned AWS account: an interactive dashboard consolidating BI insights alongside advanced forecast modeling for the Forecasting & Advanced Modeling team.
- Work under Sid Chakravarty, VP of Enterprise AI & Analytics, gaining hands-on exposure to AI strategy, decision intelligence, and forecasting/MLOps initiatives.

Software Engineer Intern

May 2025 – Aug 2026

Caterpillar Inc.

Chicago, IL

- Built CI/CD pipelines in GitHub Actions with reusable workflows and custom actions, layered with an LLMOps automation system for autonomous remediation, risk prediction, and RAG-based observability.
- Migrated Azure Pipelines to GitHub Actions and partnered with Security and CloudOps teams to modernize CI/CD infrastructure and ensure full automation coverage.
- Achieved 100% audit test coverage** for a decades-old production codebase, and built observability dashboards (CloudWatch, Prometheus, Grafana) to monitor deployed ML systems.

Software Engineer Intern

May 2024 – May 2025

State Farm

Bloomington, IL

- Developed and productionized a CNN-based car seat classification system deployed for direct customer use.
- Built and validated a labeled image dataset from scratch, enabling scalable model training and real-time inference.
- Implemented preprocessing and analytics pipelines with Pandas and NumPy to support production ML workflows.

PROJECTS

Call Center Forecasting Platform — Python, LightGBM, Time-Series Modeling

Mar 2026

- Led development of a production-style forecasting system at **UIUC Datathon** that predicted call volume, customer care time, and abandon rate at 30-minute intervals, **achieving 2nd place out of 200+ teams**.
- Engineered time-series features including lag variables, rolling statistics, and calendar effects, and deployed ensemble models to generate accurate workload forecasts across multiple portfolios.

LedgerOne: FinTech Ledger & Credit Risk Platform — Python, dbt, DuckDB

Sep 2025 – Aug 2026

- Built a fintech ledger and dbt/DuckDB analytics warehouse (staging, star schema, 5 reporting marts), **gated end-to-end by automated schema and integrity tests**.
- Extended into a credit-risk module (vintage, roll-rate, CECL reserve modeling), **validated within 0.19pp of real Freddie Mac mortgage outcomes on a holdout backtest**.

Forward Data Lab: Retrieval's Blind Spot — Python, RAG, Claude API

Aug 2026

- Ran a criteria-scored comparison of Ai2's **Asta** vs. Google Scholar across 5 query types, independently verifying every citation, and found Asta never weights synthesis by citation impact.
- Built an inspectable RAG pipeline (retrieve, rerank, cap, generate) with a relevance-confidence threshold and citation-weighted reranking **to fix that gap**, validated on real papers and live queries.